

Day 4- Types of Cyber Attacks & Detection Basics

Class Activity: Analyzing the Message

Message: *"Your account will be suspended. Click here immediately to verify your details."*

It creates urgency by saying "immediately" to panic the user into clicking without thinking.

It uses a threat by saying an "account will be suspended" to scare the user.

It asks for personal details, which no legitimate company ever asks for through a random message.

Assignment

1. Real Phishing Example

A very famous real phishing example is the PayPal Phishing Email that was widely reported. Users received an email that looked exactly like an official PayPal email saying:

"We have noticed unusual activity on your PayPal account. Your account has been temporarily limited. Please verify your identity immediately by clicking the link below, or your account will be permanently closed."

The email contained the PayPal logo, an official-looking design, and a fake link that looked like paypal-secure-login.com instead of the real paypal.com. When users clicked the link, they were taken to a fake website that stole their username, password, and credit card details.

2. Three Reasons Why It Is Phishing

Reason 1: Creates Fear and Urgency The message uses words like "immediately" and "suspended" to create panic in the user's mind. This is a very common phishing technique because when people are scared, they act quickly without thinking and end up clicking the malicious link.

Reason 2: Fake or Suspicious Link The link in the email does not go to the real website. Instead, it goes to a fake website that looks identical to the original. The URL contains extra words like "secure" or "verify" to trick the user into thinking it is legitimate.

Reason 3: Asks for Personal Information Legitimate companies like PayPal, Google or banks never ask users to verify their personal details or passwords through an email or message. Asking for sensitive information through a link is always a sign of phishing.

3. How to Prevent Phishing

Check the sender's email address Always look carefully at the email address of the sender. Phishing emails often come from addresses like support@paypa1.com instead of support@paypal.com. Even a small difference in spelling is a red flag.

Never click suspicious links Instead of clicking the link in the email always open the browser and type the official website address manually. This ensures you are going to the real website and not a fake one.

Enable Two Factor Authentication Even if an attacker gets your password they cannot login without the second verification step. Enabling two factor authentication on all important accounts adds an extra layer of security.

Use Antivirus and Anti Phishing Tools Modern browsers and antivirus software can detect and block known phishing websites automatically. Always keep them updated for better protection.